these unit cost savings to any significant extent to its customers by way of price reductions, choosing instead to retain most of these savings as profits.' Two months later, we came out with 6,700 reports written in private for US Congressmen, which gave a detailed picture of their preoccupations and sources of information. These reports are not classified, but they are only made available to Congressmen, who choose only to release some of them when it serves their own political purposes, not when the information is embarrassing or damaging to the government but important to the public. By publishing them we wanted to give American voters the opportunity to measure the actions of their elected representatives against the information with which they had been provided. We were releasing the reports on the basis of public interest, not political calculation. We posted the private emails of Sarah Palin in an attempt to highlight the fact that she was conducting political business via a private email address, arguably in order to avoid having to comply with rules about retaining copies of messages on the public record. Throughout this time we were attending conferences on journalism and free speech around the world to seed our ideas and recruit support.

I had become a full-time spare-room guy. I didn't own a car or a house. I didn't see my family much. I didn't have money and I had one pair of shoes. It was all perfectly reasonable and not an issue. I had some books and a razor and a couple of laptops. Friends would cut my hair, often while I worked, and, thankfully, when it came to equipment and costs, there always appeared to be someone willing to put their credit card where their passion was. WikiLeaks has been hand-to-mouth from day one, and maybe it has to be: it works from principle not profit, and the work, frankly, is obsessional, and was from the moment we saw how much people wanted to reveal.

I felt 2009 was going to be the start of a big few years. We were getting better at what we did, and the world was sitting up now and listening. We were refining our methods, pissing off bigger and more fearsome giants, and I began to think it would be great to find a haven from which to work. Surely, the world must possess a place that wanted to be an island of free speech, a world of anti-censorship within the larger world. For a time it appeared the *coup de grâce* would be to establish such a base in Africa, but it was too complicated there and, in a purely practical sense, too hot to store the servers. What about Sweden, Iceland, Ireland, or some other brand new